

Essential Notes: Dry Cells and Rechargeable Batteries

1. Dry Cell

- A dry cell is one of the most commonly used electric cells.
- It is called a dry cell because the electrolyte is a thick moist paste, not a liquid.
- Zinc container → Negative terminal (–).
- Carbon rod with metal cap → Positive terminal (+).
- Electrolyte paste surrounds the carbon rod.
- Dry cells are single-use cells and cannot be recharged.
- After use, they must be discarded.

2. Rechargeable Batteries

- Rechargeable batteries can be charged and used many times.
- They reduce waste and save money.
- Used in mobile phones, laptops, cameras, inverters, vehicles, and power banks.

Advantages

- ✓ Can be recharged and reused many times.
- ✓ Economical in the long run.
- ✓ Environment-friendly because less waste is produced.

Disadvantages

- ✗ Do not last forever.
- ✗ Capacity decreases after many charge-discharge cycles.
- ✗ Older batteries require charging more frequently.

Differences Between Dry Cells and Rechargeable Batteries

Dry Cell: Single-use, cannot be recharged, discarded after use.

Rechargeable Battery: Can be recharged, reused many times, produces less waste.

Remember: Dry Cell = Use Once | Rechargeable Battery = Charge and Reuse Many Times